Experiment - 2 : Setting Up a Zoho Creator Account and Exploring the Platform Architecture and Interface

Aim:

To create a Zoho Creator account and explore the platform architecture, features and user interface for developing low-code applications.

Theory:

Zoho Creator is a cloud-based low-code platform for building custom business applications with minimal coding. Applications are designed visually using forms, reports, pages and workflows.

- **Applications:** Containers that hold all forms, reports, workflows, pages and settings.
- **Forms:** Used to collect and store data, for example the Job_Application_Form.
- **Reports:** Display stored data as List, Spreadsheet, Kanban, Calendar, Map, Timeline and Pivot views.
- **Pages:** Custom screens that combine panels, charts and reports, such as a dashboard.
- **Workflows:** Automate tasks on form events such as submission or edit.
- **Deluge Script:** Zoho Creator's scripting language for validation, email and custom logic.
- **Users and Permissions:** Control access to the application through roles and permission sets.

The interface includes the Home Dashboard, Application Builder (Design, Workflow, Settings tabs), Form Designer, Report Builder, Page Builder, Workflow Builder and the Application IDE.

Procedure:

1. Open a web browser and navigate to the Zoho Creator website.

Sign in with the college Zoho account. The Creator home dashboard lists the applications available to the user.

Paste screenshot here (with browser address bar)
creator.zoho.in home page showing 'Welcome, Ayshwarya' and the application cards

Fig. 2.1: Zoho Creator Home Dashboard

2. Create a new application.

Click **Create Application** and choose **Create from scratch**. The application was named **Recruitment & Job Application Management**.

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'Create New Application' dialog with Zia, Create from scratch, Create from gallery and Import from file

Fig. 2.2: Create New Application Interface

3. Explore the Application Builder.

The new application opens in Edit mode. The **+** button adds Forms, Reports, Pages, Workflows and Chat Agents.

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'Create New Component' screen with Form, Report, Page, Workflow, Chat Agent

Fig. 2.3: Application Builder - Create New Component

4. Examine the Form Designer and add fields.

A form named **Job_Application_Form** was created and fields such as Candidate Name, Email, Phone, Department Applied For and Years Of Experience were added.

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Form builder of Job Application Form showing the field list and Field Properties panel

Fig. 2.4: Form Designer with Job Application Fields

5. Enter sample data in live mode.

Click **Access this application** and open the Job Application Form to enter a candidate record.

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Live form with candidate details filled in

Fig. 2.5: Job Application Form in Live Mode

6. View records in a report.

A list report is created automatically when a form is created. This shows the relation **Form** → **Data** → **Report**.

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All_Applications_List showing the 12 candidate records

Fig. 2.6: Report Displaying Submitted Applications

7. Explore the Workflow section.

Paste screenshot here (with browser address bar)
Workflow tab showing Form workflows, Schedules, Approvals, Blueprints, Functions

Fig. 2.7: Workflow Builder Interface

8. Explore Pages and the Page Builder.

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Recruitment_Dashboard in Page Builder with Panel, Chart, Gauge, Report elements on the left

Fig. 2.8: Page Builder Interface

9. Explore Settings, Application IDE and Deluge.

Settings contains User Permissions, Localization, Schema Builder, Application IDE, Widgets and Variables. The Application IDE shows the script of every form and report.

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Settings page with Permissions, Personalization and Developer Tools

Fig. 2.9: Application Settings

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Application IDE showing 'form Job_Application_Form' script

Fig. 2.10: Application IDE / Deluge Script Editor

10. Observe the overall platform architecture.

Application → Forms (collect data) → Reports (display and analyse data) → Pages (custom screens) → Workflows (automation) → Deluge Script (advanced logic) → Users & Permissions (access control).

Result:

A Zoho Creator account was used and the platform architecture and user interface were explored by creating the Recruitment & Job Application Management application. Zoho Creator provides forms, reports, workflows, pages and dashboards that allow rapid application development with minimal programming.